Unit I: Grammar

Grammar is the system of rules that governs how words are used in a language. It helps people speak and write correctly and clearly. Without grammar, communication may become confusing or unclear. Learning grammar improves both written and spoken English.

This unit focuses on **parts of speech, types of sentences, tenses, forming questions and negatives, and the use of articles**.

1. Review of Parts of Speech

Parts of speech are categories of words according to their function in a sentence. English grammar traditionally has **eight main parts of speech**.

1. Noun

A noun is the name of a person, place, thing, or idea.

Examples:

- Person: teacher, doctor
- Place: school, city
- Thing: book, pen
- Idea: honesty, freedom

Sentence example:

- The **student** reads a **book** in the **library**.

2. Pronoun

A pronoun is a word used instead of a noun to avoid repetition.

Examples: he, she, it, they, we, them.

Example sentence:

- Riya is my friend. **She** lives near my house.

3. Verb

A verb expresses an action or state of being.

Examples: run, write, eat, think, is, are.

Example sentence:

- The children **play** in the park.

4. Adjective

An adjective describes or modifies a noun.

Examples: big, beautiful, happy, tall.

Example sentence:

- She bought a **beautiful** dress.

5. Adverb

An adverb describes a verb, adjective, or another adverb.

Examples: quickly, slowly, very, happily.

Example sentence:

- The boy ran **quickly**.

6. Preposition

A preposition shows the relationship between a noun or pronoun and another word.

Examples: in, on, under, between, beside.

Example sentence:

- The book is **on** the table.

7. Conjunction

A conjunction connects words, phrases, or sentences.

Examples: and, but, or, because, although.

Example sentence:

- She is intelligent **and** hardworking.

8. Interjection

An interjection expresses sudden feelings or emotions.

Examples: wow!, oh!, alas!, hurrah!

Example sentence:

- **Wow!** That painting is amazing.

2. Types of Sentences

Sentences can be classified according to their purpose.

1. Declarative Sentence

A declarative sentence gives information or states a fact.

Example:

- The sun rises in the east.

2. Interrogative Sentence

An interrogative sentence asks a question.

Example:

- Where do you live?

3. Imperative Sentence

An imperative sentence gives a command, instruction, or request.

Examples:

- Close the door.
- Please help me.

4. Exclamatory Sentence

An exclamatory sentence expresses strong emotion.

Examples:

- What a beautiful day!
- How wonderful the view is!

3. Tenses

Tense shows the **time of an action** in a sentence. English has three main tenses:

- Present tense
- Past tense
- Future tense

1. Present Tense

It describes actions happening now or regularly.

Examples:

- She **writes** a letter.
- They **play** cricket every day.

2. Past Tense

It describes actions that happened in the past.

Examples:

- She **wrote** a letter yesterday.
- They **played** cricket last week.

3. Future Tense

It describes actions that will happen in the future.

Examples:

- She **will write** a letter tomorrow.
- They **will visit** the museum next week.

Tenses help speakers express time clearly in communication.

4. Forming Questions and Negatives

Forming Questions

Questions are formed by changing the order of words or by using auxiliary verbs.

Examples:

Statement:

- She is reading a book.

Question:

- **Is she reading a book?**

Another example:

Statement:

- You like coffee.

Question:

- **Do you like coffee?**

Common question words include:

- What
- Where
- When
- Why
- Who
- How

Example:

- **Where** do you live?

Forming Negative Sentences

Negative sentences express denial or contradiction. They are usually formed by adding **not** after auxiliary verbs.

Examples:

Positive:

- She is happy.

Negative:

- She is **not** happy.

Positive:

- They play football.

Negative:

- They **do not** play football.

Negative sentences are important to express disagreement or absence of action.

5. Articles

Articles are small words used before nouns to indicate whether the noun is specific or general. English has **three articles**:

- **a**
- **an**
- **the**

1. Indefinite Articles (a, an)

These are used for general or non-specific nouns.

A is used before consonant sounds.

Examples:

- a book
- a teacher
- a car

An is used before vowel sounds.

Examples:

- an apple
- an hour
- an elephant

Sentence example:

- I saw **a** dog in the street.
- She ate **an** orange.

2. Definite Article (the)

“The” is used when referring to a specific or known noun.

Examples:

- the sun
- the Taj Mahal
- the teacher

Sentence example:

- The book on the table is mine.

Unit II: Speaking Skills

Speaking skills are essential for effective communication. They help people express ideas clearly and confidently. Good speaking skills require clear pronunciation, correct grammar, appropriate vocabulary, and confidence.

This unit focuses on practical speaking activities such as **describing objects, persons, places, extempore speech, and general conversation**.

1. Describing Objects

Describing objects means explaining their **appearance, features, and use**.

While describing an object, students should mention:

- name of the object
- size and shape
- color and material
- purpose or use

Example:

"A laptop is a portable computer used for work, study, and entertainment. It has a screen, keyboard, and touchpad. People use laptops to write documents, browse the internet, and watch videos."

This activity improves vocabulary and observation skills.

2. Describing Persons

Describing a person involves explaining physical appearance, personality, and habits.

Example:

"My father is a hardworking and kind person. He is tall and has short black hair. He works as a teacher and loves reading books. He always encourages me to study and work honestly."

This type of speaking activity helps students learn how to talk about people clearly and respectfully.

3. Describing Places

Describing places means explaining the location, environment, and special features of a place.

Example:

“My college campus is very beautiful. It has large buildings, green gardens, and a big library. Students come here to study and participate in many activities. The environment is peaceful and inspiring.”

Describing places helps develop imagination and communication ability.

4. Extempore Speech

Extempore speech means speaking on a topic **without preparation**. It helps students develop confidence and quick thinking.

Example topic: **Importance of Education**

Example speech:

“Education is very important for personal and social development. It gives knowledge and helps people understand the world better. An educated person can contribute to society and make better decisions in life.”

Extempore speaking improves fluency and spontaneous communication.

5. General Conversation

General conversation refers to everyday communication between people.

It includes:

- greeting people
- asking questions
- sharing opinions
- discussing daily activities

Example conversation:

Person A: Good morning. How are you?
Person B: I am fine. Thank you. How about you?
Person A: I am doing well. What are you studying these days?
Person B: I am studying English literature.

General conversation helps learners practice **real-life communication skills**.